

## **History and Introduction to SUN**

Seniors United Now, (SUN) as it is informally known as, is a non-profit, non-partisan organization created on August 27, 2003. Our mission statement is to represent every senior in Alberta in such a way as to encourage all seniors and all seniors' organizations to speak with one voice on provincial matters that truly matter to them.

Although SUN came out of a turbulent and chaotic reaction to the Conservative cutbacks to seniors' programs in 2003 SUN has evolved into a much broader based and more credible organization that seeks to be a leading resource and advocate on seniors issues.

Our present organization is over 1300 members with a fully functioning provincial board, an executive director, a part time office manager and a part-time coordinator of volunteers. We currently have chapters located In St. Albert, Sherwood Park, Calgary, Edmonton South, Edmonton NE, and Edmonton NW with a mandate to expand to other areas of the province as our resources permit us to do so.

SUN currently works with the Seniors' Task Force under the umbrella of PIA (Public Interest Alberta) which involves such organizations as ARTA (Alberta Retired Teachers), The United Nurses of Alberta, SALT (Seniors Action Liaison Committee), ACA (Alberta Council of the Aging), Canadian Association of Retired People (CARP), Friends of Medicare, and Whitemud Citizens for Public Health to name a few.

Our provincial SUN board meets and communicates regularly with our members of the legislature to discuss and advocate on issues related to health care (long term care and home care in particular), supports and benefits, phamacare and taxation all as they pertain to seniors.

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## **VOLUNTEER OPPORTUNITIES WITH SUN**

### **Chapter Organizational Help**

- Serving on a Chapter Steering Committee (Chair, Co-Chair, Secretary)
- Organization of Chapter meetings – room set up, refreshment preparation, clean up
- Phoning meeting reminders
- Arranging and coordinating guest speakers
- Carrying out research as assigned by the Chapter Steering Committee
- These positions would report to the Chapter Steering Committees, with liaison through the Volunteer Coordinator

### **Provincial Phoning Committee**

- Carrying out Province-wide phoning tasks as assigned by the Volunteer Coordinator

### **Fundraising**

- Serving on the fundraising committee
- Researching and reporting to the board on fundraising ideas
- Carrying out the work involved for fundraising events approved by the board
- Grant writing
- Supervision provided by the Volunteer Coordinator in cooperation with the Board of Directors

### **Trade Shows/Community Events**

- Serving at SUN information booths to hand out printed information and talk with interested members of the public
- A thorough knowledge of SUN is required
- Supervision provided by the Volunteer Coordinator

### **Research Assignments**

- As requested by the Board of Directors through the Volunteer Coordinator
- Research would be related to priority issues the Board is involved in
- Reporting back to the Board through a written report – or verbal if invited by the Board

### **Board of Directors**

- Running for and serving on the Provincial Board of Directors.



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